

CODE OF PRACTICE FOR THE DEVELOPMENT OF SAFETY FRAMEWORK

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1. Purpose

This Code of Practice establishes the governance, responsibilities, process and minimum requirements for developing, approving, implementing and reviewing an organisational Safety Framework.

The Safety Framework shall provide the organisation with a clear and coherent structure for:

- defining its safety direction;
- establishing leadership expectations;
- organising the main components of safety management;
- aligning safety with corporate strategy;
- guiding the development of supporting safety systems, policies, codes, standards and procedures; and
- communicating how safety contributes to organisational outcomes.

2. Scope

This Code applies to the development or review of any organisation-wide Safety Framework, including frameworks addressing:

- sport and participant safety;
- workplace safety and health;
- safeguarding and safe sport;
- public safety;
- operational safety;
- event safety;
- facility safety; or
- an integrated safety model covering multiple safety domains.

It applies to:

- the Board or governing authority;
- Chief Executive and Executive Leadership Team;

- business and functional leaders;
- Safety Office;
- risk, legal, human resources and corporate planning functions;
- operational managers;
- safety committees;
- employees and worker representatives; and
- relevant external stakeholders.

3. Nature of a Safety Framework

A Safety Framework is a strategic governance document.

It establishes:

- the organisation's safety context;
- safety vision and mission;
- safety principles and commitments;
- safety domains or areas of responsibility;
- strategic drivers, pillars or enablers;
- governance and accountability;
- intended safety outcomes;
- relationship with supporting safety documents; and
- the basis for implementation and performance review.

A Safety Framework shall not normally contain detailed operating procedures, work instructions, technical specifications or task-level controls.

Such requirements shall be established through the supporting Safety Management System, Codes of Practice, standards, manuals, plans and procedures.

4. Principles

The development of the Safety Framework shall be guided by the following principles.

4.1 Leadership Ownership

The Safety Framework shall be owned by the organisation's leadership.

The Safety Office may coordinate, facilitate and draft the Framework, but shall not determine the organisation's strategic safety direction independently.

4.2 Strategic Alignment

The Safety Framework shall align with:

- organisational mandate;
- corporate vision and mission;
- strategic priorities;
- organisational values;
- governance arrangements;
- risk management approach; and
- stakeholder expectations.

4.3 Context-Based Development

The Framework shall be based on an understanding of the organisation's internal and external context.

It shall reflect the nature, scale, complexity and risk profile of the organisation's activities.

4.4 Proportionality

The depth and complexity of the Framework shall be proportionate to:

- organisational size;
- operating environment;
- legal obligations;
- safety risk exposure;
- stakeholder impact; and
- organisational capability.

4.5 Consultation and Participation

Relevant internal and external stakeholders shall be consulted during development.

The Framework shall reflect practical operational needs and shall not be developed solely as a corporate or technical exercise.

4.6 Integration

Safety shall be integrated into organisational governance, strategy, planning, operations, people management, procurement, assurance and performance management.

4.7 Clarity

The Framework shall be concise, understandable and capable of being communicated to both internal and external stakeholders.

4.8 Continual Improvement

The Framework shall support systematic learning, performance review and continual improvement.

5. Governance and Responsibilities

5.1 Board or Governing Authority

The Board or governing authority shall, where applicable:

- provide strategic oversight;
- consider significant safety risks;
- confirm alignment with organisational governance;
- endorse the proposed safety direction;
- review major organisational commitments; and
- monitor implementation and performance.

5.2 Chief Executive

The Chief Executive shall:

- sponsor the development of the Safety Framework;
- establish the mandate and intended outcomes;
- ensure that appropriate leaders and functions participate;
- approve or recommend the Framework for Board approval;
- ensure that resources are available for implementation; and
- hold senior leaders accountable for its application.

5.3 Executive Leadership Team

The Executive Leadership Team shall:

- define the strategic safety direction;
- review organisational context and significant risks;
- agree on the structure and major components of the Framework;
- confirm leadership commitments;
- establish intended outcomes;

- consider resource and implementation implications; and
- oversee integration into business planning.

5.4 Executive Sponsor

An Executive Sponsor shall be appointed to:

- provide authority and direction;
- resolve strategic issues;
- secure leadership participation;
- oversee consultation;
- present the Framework for approval; and
- support organisation-wide implementation.

5.5 Safety Office

The Safety Office shall:

- coordinate the development process;
- prepare the context and evidence base;
- facilitate leadership and stakeholder engagements;
- advise on safety management principles and obligations;
- prepare draft documents;
- maintain consultation and decision records;
- coordinate review and approval;
- support communication and implementation; and
- coordinate subsequent review.

The Safety Office shall not approve its own draft unless formally authorised.

5.6 Business and Functional Leaders

Business and functional leaders shall:

- identify operational and functional safety issues;
- contribute to the Framework's development;
- test whether proposed components are relevant and implementable;
- identify resource and capability implications;
- integrate the approved Framework into business plans; and
- report progress and constraints.

5.7 Managers and Supervisors

Managers and supervisors shall:

- provide operational input;
- consult employees;
- identify implementation issues;
- communicate the approved Framework;
- translate strategic direction into local actions; and
- monitor application within their areas.

5.8 Employees and Representatives

Employees and worker representatives shall be given reasonable opportunities to:

- identify safety concerns and priorities;
- provide practical input;
- comment on proposed principles and commitments;
- identify barriers to implementation; and
- contribute improvement suggestions.

6. Initiating Development

The development or review of the Safety Framework shall be formally authorised.

The initiating document shall define:

- purpose;
- scope;
- Executive Sponsor;
- development lead;
- intended stakeholders;
- decision-making authority;
- expected outputs;
- programme timeline; and
- approval authority.

Development should be initiated where:

- no formal Safety Framework exists;
- the organisation is establishing a new safety system;

- organisational strategy changes;
- major restructuring occurs;
- significant new activities or risks arise;
- legal or regulatory requirements change;
- serious incidents reveal systemic weaknesses; or
- the existing Framework is no longer relevant or effective.

7. Development Process

7.1 Establish the Development Team

A cross-functional development team shall be formed.

The team should include representatives from:

- executive leadership;
- Safety Office;
- operations;
- risk management;
- legal or compliance;
- human resources;
- corporate planning;
- communications;
- facilities or engineering, where relevant;
- procurement or contract management;
- employee or worker representatives; and
- other relevant specialist functions.

The team shall have clear terms of reference, roles and decision-making arrangements.

7.2 Assess the Organisational Context

The development team shall assess the internal and external context.

The assessment shall consider:

Internal context

- organisational mandate and purpose;
- corporate strategy and values;
- governance structure;
- operating model;

- activities and services;
- workforce profile;
- facilities and assets;
- existing safety arrangements;
- organisational culture;
- capability and resources;
- incident and performance history;
- assurance findings; and
- competing organisational priorities.

External context

- legal and regulatory obligations;
- industry and professional expectations;
- stakeholder expectations;
- community and public concerns;
- contractor and partner arrangements;
- social, environmental and technological changes;
- emerging risks;
- national or sector strategies; and
- relevant standards and guidance.

The context assessment shall identify the main issues that the Safety Framework must address.

7.3 Identify Stakeholders and Their Needs

The development team shall identify relevant stakeholders and determine their safety-related needs and expectations.

Stakeholders may include:

- employees;
- participants;
- customers;
- visitors;
- members of the public;
- contractors;
- volunteers;
- partners;
- regulators;

- emergency services;
- industry bodies;
- unions;
- insurers;
- community groups; and
- governing authorities.

Stakeholder expectations shall be evaluated based on relevance, significance and the organisation's ability or obligation to address them.

7.4 Identify Legal and Other Obligations

Applicable legal, regulatory, contractual and organisational obligations shall be identified.

The Framework shall not reproduce detailed legal requirements but shall establish the organisation's commitment to comply with applicable obligations.

Detailed obligations shall be maintained in a separate legal and other requirements register.

7.5 Review Significant Safety Risks

The development team shall review the organisation's significant safety risks.

This review shall consider:

- persons who may be affected;
- nature and scale of harm;
- operational activities;
- facilities and environments;
- vulnerable groups;
- contractors and partners;
- foreseeable emergencies;
- systemic and organisational risks; and
- emerging risks.

The Framework shall address the management of safety at a strategic level and shall not replace operational risk assessments.

7.6 Conduct Leadership Safety Planning Workshop

A leadership workshop shall be conducted to establish the organisation's strategic safety direction.

The workshop shall address:

- intended future safety state;
- relationship between safety and corporate strategy;
- leadership expectations;
- safety principles and values;
- major safety domains;
- strategic priorities;
- organisational commitments;
- acceptable and unacceptable practices;
- desired culture and behaviours;
- governance arrangements;
- intended outcomes; and
- measures of success.

The workshop shall be attended by the Chief Executive, Executive Sponsor, relevant senior leaders and the Safety Office.

Decisions and actions shall be documented.

7.7 Define the Framework Architecture

The development team shall define the architecture of the Safety Framework.

The architecture should include, where relevant:

1. organisational context;
2. safety vision;
3. safety mission;
4. safety principles;
5. safety domains;
6. strategic drivers;
7. pillars or enablers;
8. governance and accountability;
9. stakeholder engagement;
10. implementation arrangements;
11. intended outcomes;
12. performance and assurance; and
13. relationship with supporting documents.

The structure shall be logical, non-duplicative and capable of being represented in both written and visual form.

7.8 Develop the Safety Vision and Mission

The Safety Vision shall describe the organisation's intended long-term safety outcome.

The Safety Mission shall describe how the organisation will work towards that outcome.

Both statements shall:

- align with the corporate direction;
- be clear and concise;
- reflect the organisation's mandate;
- remain sufficiently stable over time; and
- guide the development of supporting safety documents.

7.9 Define Safety Domains

The Framework shall identify the main areas of safety responsibility relevant to the organisation.

Examples may include:

- workplace safety and health;
- participant or customer safety;
- public safety;
- safe sport and safeguarding;
- facility safety;
- event safety;
- contractor safety;
- emergency preparedness; and
- operational resilience.

Each domain shall be clearly defined to prevent overlap, omission or confusion.

7.10 Define Strategic Drivers

Strategic drivers shall describe the broad organisational capabilities or conditions required to achieve the Safety Vision.

Examples include:

- commitment;
- culture;

- competency;
- control;
- collaboration;
- communication; and
- continual improvement.

Each driver shall:

- have a clear purpose;
- be distinct from other drivers;
- support the intended safety outcomes;
- be applicable across the organisation; and
- be capable of implementation through supporting initiatives.

7.11 Define Pillars or Enablers

Each strategic driver may be supported by pillars or enablers.

Pillars or enablers shall describe the key areas of organisational action required to activate the driver.

They should be:

- concise;
- specific;
- non-duplicative;
- strategically relevant;
- understandable to intended users; and
- capable of being expanded in supporting documents.

Detailed initiatives, processes and procedures shall not be included in the Framework unless necessary to explain the model.

7.12 Define Governance and Accountability

The Framework shall establish:

- leadership accountability;
- oversight arrangements;
- role of the Safety Office;
- responsibilities of business units;
- manager and employee responsibilities;
- committee structures;

- escalation arrangements;
- assurance responsibilities; and
- reporting arrangements.

The Framework shall distinguish between:

- accountability for safety;
- responsibility for implementation; and
- technical support provided by the Safety Office.

7.13 Define Intended Outcomes

The Framework shall identify the safety outcomes the organisation intends to achieve.

Outcomes may include:

- prevention of fatalities and serious harm;
- safe participation and service delivery;
- safe and healthy workplaces;
- strengthened leadership and accountability;
- improved safety culture;
- competent personnel;
- effective risk controls;
- transparent reporting;
- organisational learning;
- stakeholder confidence; and
- continual improvement.

Outcomes shall be strategic and shall not be confused with annual performance targets.

7.14 Define the Picture of Success

Where appropriate, the Framework should describe the intended organisational state when the Framework is effectively implemented.

The picture of success may address:

- safety integrated into decision-making;
- leaders demonstrating consistent safety ownership;
- personnel competent and confident to act safely;
- risks identified and managed early;
- reporting encouraged and acted upon;
- functions collaborating effectively;

- evidence-based assurance;
- safe delivery supporting organisational performance; and
- increased trust among stakeholders.

7.15 Establish the Document Hierarchy

The Framework shall define its relationship with other safety documents.

A typical hierarchy is:

1. Corporate Strategy;
2. Safety Framework;
3. Safety Policy;
4. Safety Management System;
5. Codes of Practice;
6. Standards and Guidelines;
7. Operational Manuals;
8. Plans and Procedures;
9. Work Instructions and Forms; and
10. Records and Evidence.

Lower-level documents shall support and remain consistent with the Safety Framework.

8. Drafting Requirements

The Safety Framework shall:

- use clear and authoritative language;
- distinguish strategic intent from operational requirements;
- avoid unnecessary technical detail;
- avoid duplication with supporting documents;
- define important terms consistently;
- use diagrams only where they improve understanding;
- explain the relationship between components;
- identify intended users;
- state its governance status; and
- include document control information.

The main Framework should remain concise.

Detailed supporting information shall be placed in annexes or separate implementation documents.

9. Consultation and Validation

9.1 Internal Consultation

The draft Framework shall be reviewed by relevant internal stakeholders.

Consultation should include:

- Executive Leadership Team;
- business units;
- operational managers;
- Safety Office;
- legal or compliance;
- risk management;
- human resources;
- corporate planning;
- communications;
- safety committees;
- employee or worker representatives; and
- relevant specialist functions.

9.2 External Consultation

External consultation may be conducted where the Framework affects or depends on:

- regulators;
- strategic partners;
- contractors;
- industry bodies;
- national sport organisations;
- facility operators;
- emergency services;
- insurers;
- community representatives; or
- other affected stakeholders.

9.3 Validation

The draft shall be validated to determine whether it is:

- strategically aligned;
- legally appropriate;
- operationally relevant;
- complete;
- understandable;
- implementable;
- proportionate; and
- capable of supporting the development of the Safety Management System.

Validation may include:

- workshops;
- interviews;
- focus groups;
- pilot application;
- scenario testing;
- document mapping; and
- independent review.

9.4 Consultation Records

The Safety Office shall maintain records of:

- stakeholders consulted;
- consultation method;
- feedback received;
- proposed amendments;
- decisions taken; and
- rationale where significant feedback is not accepted.

10. Approval

The final Safety Framework shall be reviewed by the Executive Leadership Team.

The Framework shall be approved by:

- the Chief Executive; or
- the Board or governing authority, where required by organisational governance.

Before approval, leadership shall confirm that:

- the Framework aligns with corporate strategy;
- significant safety risks have been considered;
- legal and stakeholder expectations have been addressed;
- governance arrangements are clear;
- implementation is reasonably achievable;
- sufficient resources can be provided; and
- supporting systems and documents will be developed or updated.

The approved Framework shall include:

- document title;
- document owner;
- version number;
- approval authority;
- approval date;
- effective date;
- review date; and
- document classification.

11. Implementation Planning

Approval of the Safety Framework shall be followed by an implementation plan.

The implementation plan shall identify:

- priority workstreams;
- actions;
- accountable owners;
- supporting parties;
- required resources;
- milestones;
- dependencies;
- performance measures;
- communication activities;
- capability requirements;
- supporting documents to be developed or revised; and
- reporting arrangements.

Implementation may be phased according to organisational priority, risk and capability.

The Safety Framework shall not be considered fully implemented solely because it has been approved or published.

12. Communication

The organisation shall communicate the approved Framework to relevant stakeholders.

Communication should explain:

- why the Framework was developed;
- what it contains;
- how it supports the organisation's strategy;
- what leadership has committed to;
- how roles and responsibilities are affected;
- how it will be implemented; and
- how progress will be measured.

Communication may include:

- leadership briefings;
- staff engagement sessions;
- induction programmes;
- management workshops;
- digital publication;
- visual summaries;
- posters and infographics;
- contractor briefings; and
- stakeholder engagement sessions.

The level of detail shall be appropriate to the audience.

13. Integration

The Framework shall be integrated into:

- corporate planning;
- business planning;
- enterprise risk management;
- budgeting;
- workforce planning;
- leadership performance expectations;
- procurement;
- contract management;
- project governance;
- programme and event planning;
- facility management;
- training and competency development;
- assurance; and
- performance reporting.

Business and functional leaders shall identify how the Framework applies within their areas.

14. Monitoring and Evaluation

The organisation shall monitor whether the Safety Framework is:

- understood;
- implemented;
- integrated;
- adequately resourced;
- producing intended outcomes; and
- supported by effective systems and controls.

Monitoring may include:

- implementation progress;
- leadership participation;
- completion of supporting documents;
- integration into business plans;

- employee awareness;
- safety performance trends;
- audit and assurance findings;
- stakeholder feedback;
- maturity assessments; and
- management review.

The Safety Office shall coordinate reporting to the Executive Leadership Team.

15. Review

The Safety Framework shall be reviewed:

- at planned intervals;
- following significant strategic or organisational change;
- following serious or systemic incidents;
- following material changes to legal obligations;
- where implementation reveals significant weaknesses;
- where stakeholder expectations materially change; or
- when directed by the Chief Executive or Board.

A formal review should be conducted at least once every three years.

The review shall assess:

- continuing relevance;
- strategic alignment;
- adequacy of the Framework architecture;
- effectiveness of governance;
- implementation progress;
- achievement of intended outcomes;
- emerging risks;
- stakeholder expectations; and
- need for revision.

A decision to retain the Framework without amendment shall be documented.

16. Document Control and Records

The Safety Office shall retain records of:

- development authorisation;
- terms of reference;
- context assessment;
- stakeholder analysis;
- legal and obligation review;
- risk review;
- leadership workshop records;
- draft versions;
- consultation feedback;
- validation findings;
- approval records;
- communication materials;
- implementation plans;
- monitoring reports;
- review decisions; and
- superseded versions.

Only the current approved version shall be made available for organisational use.

17. Assurance

The organisation shall periodically assess whether:

- the prescribed development process was followed;
- leadership was meaningfully involved;
- the Framework reflects the organisation's risks and context;
- stakeholder consultation was adequate;
- supporting documents remain aligned;
- roles and responsibilities are implemented;
- performance information is reliable;
- the Framework is integrated into business processes; and
- identified gaps are addressed.

Assurance may be conducted through:

- internal audit;
- management review;
- independent review;
- governance review;
- safety maturity assessment;
- document alignment review; or
- external assessment.

18. Non-Conformance

The following shall be treated as non-conformance with this Code:

- development without formal leadership sponsorship;
- drafting solely by the Safety Office without leadership input;
- failure to assess organisational context;
- failure to consider significant safety risks;
- failure to consult relevant stakeholders;
- unclear governance or accountability;
- approval by an unauthorised person;
- publication without an implementation plan;
- inconsistency with corporate strategy;
- duplication or conflict with supporting safety documents;
- failure to review an outdated Framework; or
- continued use of a superseded version.

Non-conformances shall be recorded, assigned to an accountable owner and addressed within a defined timeframe.

Annex A — Minimum Safety Framework Structure

Section	Minimum Content
1. Introduction	Purpose, scope and intended audience
2. Organisational Context	Internal and external context
3. Strategic Alignment	Relationship with corporate strategy
4. Safety Vision	Desired future safety state
5. Safety Mission	How the organisation will achieve the vision
6. Safety Principles	Values and guiding principles
7. Safety Domains	Main areas of safety responsibility
8. Strategic Drivers	Organisational capabilities required
9. Pillars or Enablers	Key areas supporting each driver
10. Governance	Leadership and accountability arrangements
11. Intended Outcomes	Strategic safety outcomes
12. Picture of Success	Intended organisational end state
13. Implementation	High-level implementation approach
14. Monitoring and Review	Performance, assurance and review
15. Document Hierarchy	Relationship with supporting documents

Annex B — Recommended Development Sequence

Stage	Activity	Intended Output
1	Confirm mandate and sponsor	Approved development brief
2	Establish development team	Terms of reference
3	Assess organisational context	Context assessment
4	Identify stakeholders	Stakeholder analysis
5	Review obligations and risks	Obligations and risk summary
6	Conduct leadership workshop	Agreed strategic direction
7	Define Framework architecture	Approved structure
8	Draft Framework	Draft document and visual model
9	Conduct consultation	Consultation record
10	Validate Framework	Validation findings
11	Finalise and approve	Approved Framework
12	Develop implementation plan	Implementation roadmap
13	Communicate and integrate	Communication and integration records
14	Monitor and review	Performance and review reports

Annex C — Responsibility Matrix

Activity	Board	Chief Executive	Executive Sponsor	Executive Leadership	Safety Office	Business Leaders	Employees / Reps
Authorise development	C/A	A	R	C	I	I	I
Establish development team	I	A	R	C	R	C	I
Assess context	I	A	C	C	R	C	C
Review risks and obligations	I	A	C	C	R	C	C
Define strategic direction	C	A	R	R	C	C	I
Define architecture	I	A	R	C	R	C	I
Draft Framework	I	I	C	C	R	C	I
Conduct consultation	I	I	C	C	R	C	C
Validate Framework	I	A	R	C	R	C	C
Approve Framework	A/C	A	R	C	I	I	I
Implement Framework	I	A	C	R	C	R	C
Monitor performance	I	A	C	C	R	R	C
Review Framework	C	A	R	C	R	C	C

Legend

- **R** — Responsible
- **A** — Accountable
- **C** — Consulted
- **I** — Informed

Annex D — Minimum Development Records

No.	Record	Record Owner
1	Development mandate	Executive Sponsor
2	Development team terms of reference	Safety Office
3	Organisational context assessment	Safety Office
4	Stakeholder analysis	Safety Office
5	Legal and other obligations summary	Legal / Safety Office
6	Significant safety risk summary	Safety Office / Risk Function
7	Leadership workshop record	Safety Office
8	Framework architecture decision	Executive Sponsor
9	Draft versions	Safety Office
10	Consultation record	Safety Office
11	Validation report	Development Team
12	Approval record	Chief Executive's Office
13	Implementation plan	Relevant Executive Owner
14	Communication records	Communications / Safety Office
15	Monitoring and review records	Safety Office